

shifted from whether AI works to where it delivers measurable clinical and business value.

“People think AI is cheap because tokens are available. Remove the tokens and it’s going to be very expensive,” says Ramprasad.

This is particularly relevant in a price-sensitive healthcare market like India where providers must weigh AI investment against affordability. Even in radiology, one of healthcare’s most mature AI user segment, AI-assisted reporting can cost more than the conventional reporting by human radiologists, says Ramprasad.

### ACCESS, AFFORDABILITY

“AI is here to stay, and it will undoubtedly transform healthcare. But we need to be realistic. It won’t solve every problem,” says Ramprasad, adding that there are areas where AI is creating tremendous value. The others will continue to require human expertise, he says. Cost remains a critical consideration.

Reddy says in healthcare, the return cannot be measured in terms of time or money. “We look at whether a technology enables earlier diagnosis, improves clinical outcomes, enhances patient safety, reduces unnecessary variation in care, and allows our clinical teams to spend more time with patients. Those are the returns that matter the most,” she says. “AI does not change the fundamentals by which healthcare should be judged. The primary measures remain outcomes, access and affordability,” she adds.

The earliest benefits are visible in faster documentation, improved scheduling and discharge planning, better use of hospital capacity, and less time spent on repetitive administrative work.

The larger opportunity lies in prevention and clinical outcomes.



**“Our investments [in AI] have evolved. AI does not change the fundamentals by which healthcare should be judged. The primary measures remain outcomes, access and affordability”**

**SANGITA REDDY**

JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR,  
APOLLO HOSPITALS  
ENTERPRISE



**“Healthcare costs are extremely important in markets like India. AI solutions will take time to percolate. There are certain sweet spots which can be easily handled by AI. But it will not be able to impact every aspect of healthcare”**

**VEDAM RAMPRASAD**  
CEO, MEDGENOME

If AI helps identify risk earlier or enables intervention before a patient’s condition deteriorates, it may reduce complications and the cost of late-stage care.

An EY report says GenAI applications in health and life sciences could contribute an incremental \$64 billion to India’s GDP by 2030, underscoring the far-reaching potential of GenAI in reshaping the industry.

### RESPONSIBLE AI

While the discussion on AI implementation and ROI goes on, data privacy and governance are emerging as equally important challenges.

Healthcare leaders argue that AI can only scale if it is built on secure data-sharing frameworks, robust cybersecurity and clear regulatory standards. While India’s Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act is expected to provide the foundation, much of the healthcare ecosystem—particularly smaller providers—still lacks the infrastructure and processes needed for compliance. Strengthening governance, they say, is fundamental to building trust in AI.

Responsible AI also requires investment in data, electronic medical records, integration, cybersecurity, validation, trusted research environments, governance and upskilling. Its economic impact will ultimately be determined not by how many tools a hospital launches, but by how many become part of everyday care and deliver sustained value. This will only be tested over a period of time. Industry experts say investment alone will not determine AI adoption and success.

In an industry where trust is as important as technology, AI’s biggest test in healthcare is only just beginning. **BT**

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